

Special Supplier Audit – Severn Subsea Cables

Newport factory · 11–12 August 2026

Elena Márquez · 21 August 2026 · WE-PRC-AUD-2026-08

Field	Details
Supplier	Severn Subsea Cables Ltd, Newport
Contract	WE-CON-2025-031
Date	11–12 August 2026
Auditors	Laura Kessler (lead), Mei Tanaka, external HV specialist
Trigger	Factory test failure of export cable 2 on 20 July 2026 (HB-RISK-017)
Result	Improvement required – 1 major, 4 minor findings

1. Background

On 21 July 2026 Severn Subsea Cables notified a breakdown during the high-voltage test of export cable 2 for Harrow Bay. This special audit verified the root cause analysis, the containment of other affected products and the adequacy of the recovery programme.



Turntable with export cable 2 during the audit

2. Findings

#	Finding	Class
M1	Clean-room air handling filter maintenance not covered by the	Major

	preventive maintenance plan; particle count not monitored continuously – direct contributor to the FJ-2/07 defect	
m1	Factory joint X-ray only on a sampling basis (25 %)	Minor
m2	Late notification: the breakdown occurred on 20 July, Weyland was informed on 21 July 16:40 (contract: within 24 h – met, but internal escalation took 19 h)	Minor
m3	Sub-supplier of semi-conductive compound not audited since 2023	Minor
m4	Recovery programme lacks float for the type test of the revised factory joint	Minor

3. Agreed actions

- Continuous particle monitoring with alarms in both joint clean rooms – implemented 10 August (verified)
- 100 % X-ray of all factory joints for Harrow Bay
- Weyland inspector present for all remaining factory joints of export cable 2
- Weekly re-manufacture progress report every Friday until load-out

4. Conclusion

The root cause is credible and the corrective actions are adequate. The recovery date of 12 March 2027 is achievable but has little float. Severn remains an approved supplier under **enhanced monitoring** until the successful type test of the revised factory joint. Re-audit planned for January 2027.